Northwind Labs Travel and Expense Policy

Booking Travel

All business travel must be booked through the company travel portal at least 14 days in advance where possible. Economy class is standard for flights under 6 hours; premium economy may be booked for longer flights. Business class requires approval from a vice president.

Hotels and Daily Allowances

Hotel costs are capped per night. Choose hotels within walking distance or a short taxi ride of your meeting location. The daily allowance (per diem) covers meals and incidental expenses.

Location	Hotel cap per night	Daily allowance
Major cities (London, New York, Tokyo)	$250	$90
Other cities	$180	$70

Reimbursement Process

To be reimbursed, submit an expense claim in the finance portal within 30 days of the expense. Claims submitted later than 30 days require written approval from your department head and may be rejected. Each claim must include an itemised receipt; card statements on their own are not accepted as proof of purchase.

Claims under $500 are approved by your direct manager. Claims of $500 or more also require approval from Finance. Approved claims are paid with the next monthly payroll run, provided they are approved by the 20th of the month. Claims approved after the 20th are paid in the following month's payroll.

If you lose a receipt, complete a missing receipt declaration in the finance portal. Missing receipt declarations are accepted for expenses up to $75, and no more than three times in a calendar year. Repeated missing receipts will be raised with your manager.

Expenses paid in a foreign currency are reimbursed in your home currency using the exchange rate shown on your card statement, or the published central bank rate on the date of the expense if you paid in cash. Bank fees for foreign transactions on personal cards are reimbursable when listed as a separate line item.

Company cards may be used only for business expenses. Personal purchases on a company card, even if repaid, are a breach of this policy. Card holders must reconcile their card transactions in the finance portal by the 5th of each month.

Mileage for business journeys in a personal car is reimbursed at $0.60 per mile. Record the start and end locations and the purpose of each journey in the claim. Commuting between your home and your usual place of work is not a business journey and cannot be claimed, even when you work outside normal hours.

For trips longer than two weeks you may request a travel advance of up to 50% of the estimated costs. Advances must be requested at least 10 days before departure and are settled against your expense claim when you return. Any unspent advance must be repaid within 30 days of the end of the trip.

Non-Reimbursable Items

- Alcohol, except when hosting customers with manager approval.
- Traffic and parking fines.
- Upgrades to flights or hotel rooms paid for personally.
- Personal entertainment such as in-flight films, spa or gym fees.